

intuitively and in line with our own values, rather than according to fleeting whims and feelings of comparison.

‘The type of rapid consumption we do in the US and UK is often habitual and it’s important to recognize that first and foremost. But it doesn’t help that you’ve got politicians telling you to go out and spend to “help” the economy, like it’s our job to restore something so easily broken,’ she warned. ‘The first thing I always tell people is please stop buying so much. I’m not going to sit here from a perch of judgement because I used to be quite the fast fashion consumer, but the minute I started to question it, the process of constantly buying was immediately less appealing to me. The more time I took away from the idea that I needed a new clothing item monthly, the more I started to question what I had been doing all along. I suggest to people that they take a break from the places they’re tempted to spend at and replace those visits with other activities. Volunteering for example. Visiting art museums. I also suggest recognizing what pushes you to spend. Do you buy when you feel sad? When you need a burst of confidence? When you’re bored? Investigate those feelings. Lastly, and this is the most important tip of all, unsubscribe and unfollow the places that get the bulk of your money so much that you feel hostage to them . . . break up with them immediately. If you can’t live without, you can always go back. But having a soft break up might often turn into a hard one.’

As someone I often look to for guidance and insights into how to navigate consumerism, I found it encouraging that so much